

an INMOS (a British company) transputer (INMOS named its parallel-processing-capable microprocessors transputers), the PARAM 8000 was capable of a peak processing power of 1 Gigafllops per second. It had 1 GB of RAM and a 20 GB hard disk. The Param used an advanced parallel programming environment called Paras. With Param 8000, India became the fifth nation capable of building supercomputers. Though the design and development were done indigenously, the building blocks—CPU, RAM, hard disks, etc.—still had to be imported. The Param was eventually exported to other countries.

August: Linux Is Born

A Finnish student put out a little message in the comp.os.minix newsgroup informing users of Minix, a UNIX-like operating system, about his attempt to create a free operating system based on UNIX. The student was Linus Torvalds. Within a month the first version of Linus' work was available for download and improvement. The folder from which the code could be downloaded was named "Linux" by the administrator, and this name passed on to the OS. Linus' choice was "FREIX" referring to "FREE" and "UNIX". The first version to be available for download was 0.02.

1992: The First Linux Distro—And GNU/Linux

January: PDA Conceived

Apple Computer chairman John Sculley coined the term Personal Digital Assistant (PDA), referring to handheld computers that typically operate via a stylus on an LCD display. PDAs were intended to improve upon Personal Information Managers, which used to store phone numbers and short memos.

January: ERNET, Internet Starts In India

ERNET (Education and Research Network), a division of the Department of Electronics under the Indian Government, began offering dialup Internet connectivity to premier educational and